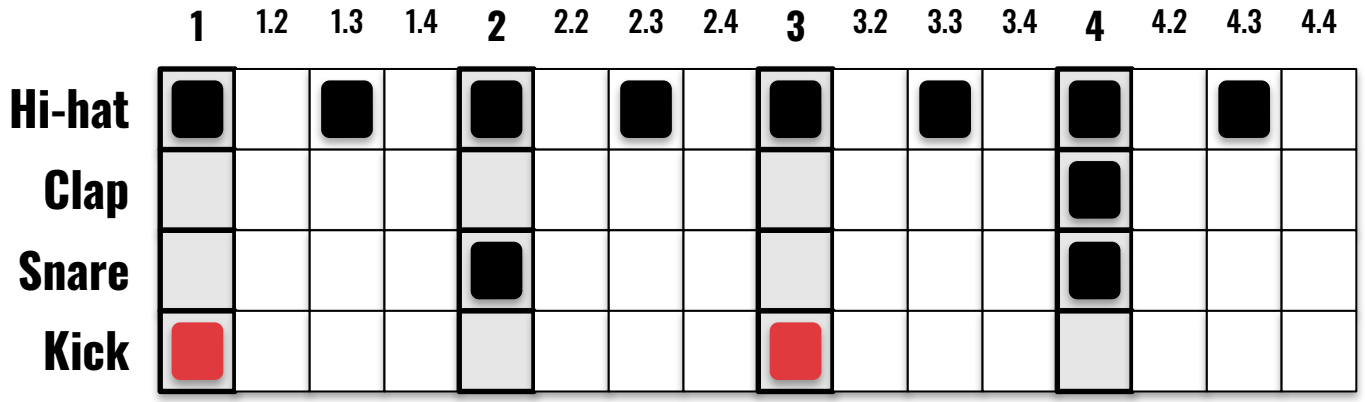
HUDSON BEAT



BEAT FROM NOTHING

Feat. Billie Jean

LISTEN FIRST

BILLIE JEAN · MICHAEL JACKSON

Teacher: play about 60 seconds from YouTube or Spotify.

- What do you hear?
- What's repeating?
- What enters, and when?

WHAT THE HECK IS A LOOP?

- A repeated musical idea
- Simple or complex!
- Builds on previous material

WHICH INSTRUMENTS LOOP?

DRUMS

hi-hat
snare
kick

PERCUSSION

shaker

BASS

the lowest sound

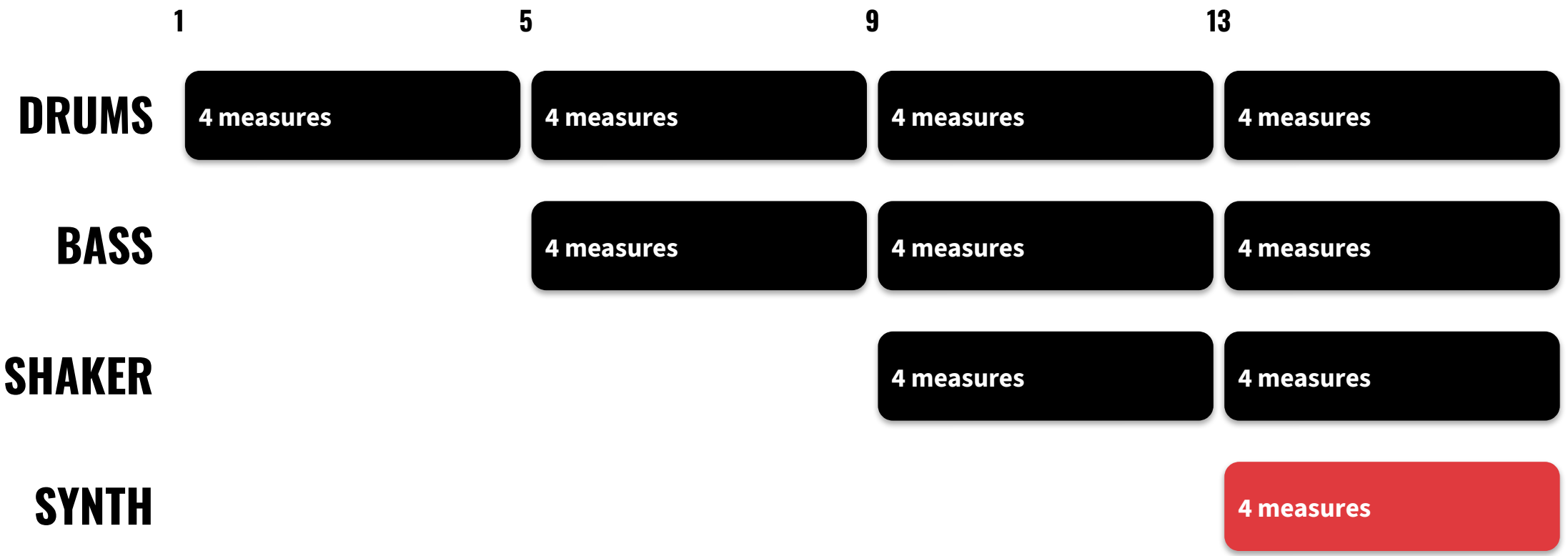
SYNTH

chords and color

HOW LONG IS EACH LOOP?

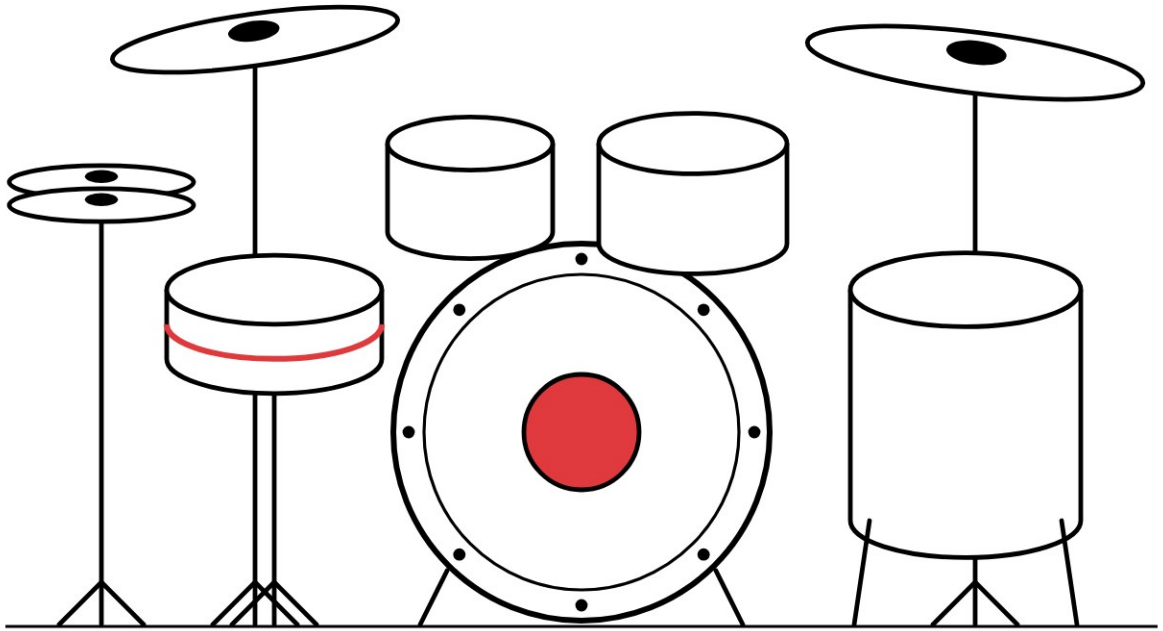
- Clap along to the pulse: each clap is a BEAT
- Most of the time there are 4 beats in a MEASURE (bar)
- How many beats do the drums play by themselves?
- How many measures is that?

MAPPING AN INTRO, LAYER BY LAYER



Each layer enters at the start of a 4-measure block and keeps looping. In Logic, every block is a region.

MEET THE KIT



- **KICK**

  the lowest, heaviest hit; usually beats 1 and 3

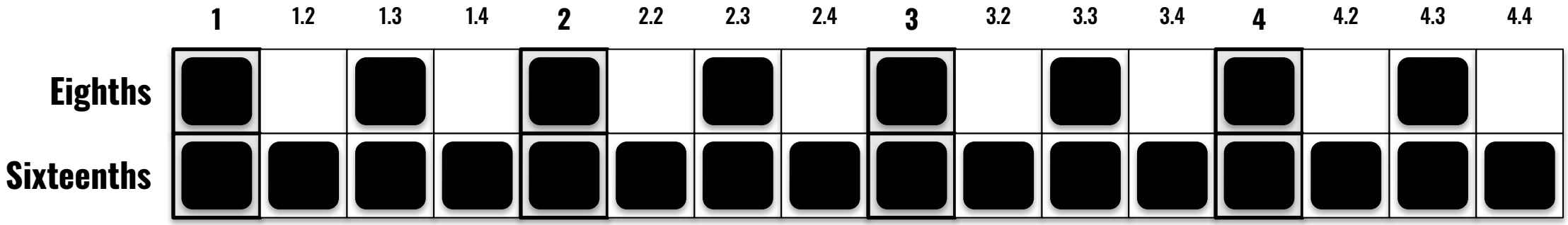
- **SNARE**

  the sharp crack; usually beats 2 and 4

- **HI-HAT**

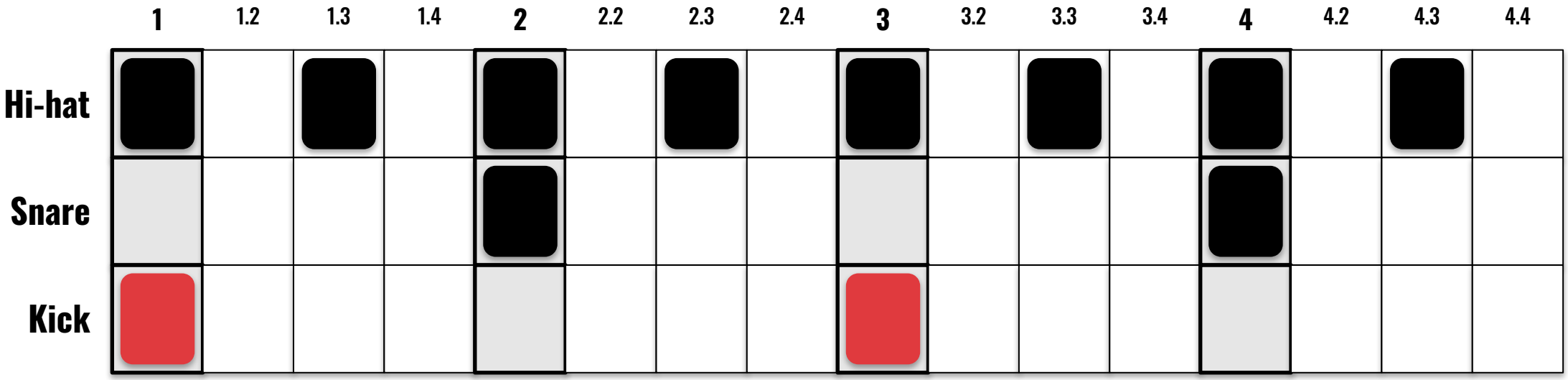
  two cymbals that keep a steady pulse; closed (tight) or open (ringing)

READ THE GRID



- 16 squares = 1 measure of sixteenth notes
- Every other square = eighth notes (the default groove)
- Every square = sixteenth notes (busier, more energy)

WORKED EXAMPLE: BILLIE JEAN'S DRUMS



BILLIE JEAN · MICHAEL JACKSON · 116 BPM

Hi-hat in eighth notes · snare on 2 and 4 · kick on 1 and 3
Teacher: play the song from YouTube or Spotify and compare.

IN LOGIC

1. Create a Software Instrument track and choose any Electronic Drum Kit (this loads Drum Machine Designer)
2. Control-click (right-click) in the track at bar 1, then choose Create Pattern Region
3. Double-click the region to open the Step Sequencer
4. Click squares to place hits; press C to Cycle the measure
5. Set the tempo in the control bar (116 for Billie Jean)

YOUR PROJECT: BEAT FROM NOTHING

- An original drum beat, built from nothing
- No loops, no pre-made grooves
- Kick, snare, closed hi-hat + at least one extra sound
- 16 measures in AABA form, mixed with volume and panning

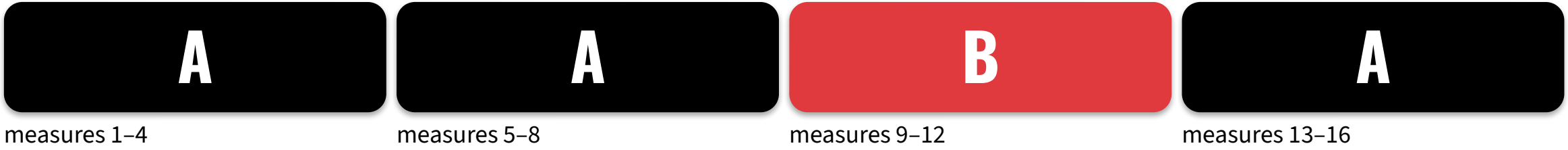
THE STEPS

DAY 1 Name the kit · loops · listening

DAY 2 Copy a famous pattern

DAY 3 Build A · build B · arrange AABA · mix · submit

DAY 4 Present + feedback



B = A with one change: remove one element, add one sound, or change the hi-hat rhythm.

WHAT YOU TURN IN

- [ ] Beat built in Drum Machine Designer, no Apple Loops
- [ ] Volume set on every track, nothing at default
- [ ] Panning on at least 2 tracks
- [ ] Named: Your Name – Beat From Nothing
- [ ] MP3 + compressed .logicx, submitted before presenting
- [ ] Three feedback questions posted before presenting

HOW IT'S SCORED

CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	5 = Beat has a distinct feel and personality. B section creates meaningful contrast. Goes beyond the obvious.	/ 5
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	5 = Drum Machine Designer used confidently. Pattern regions, 64-step, or note repeat used with control.	/ 5
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	5 = AABA structure is clear and musically satisfying. Beat locks in and feels complete.	/ 5
VOLUME & BALANCE	5 = All elements are balanced with intention. Each drum sound has its own space. Panning adds width without distraction.	/ 5
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	5 = Project correctly named, submitted on time. Confident presentation. Three thoughtful feedback questions posted.	/ 5

TOTAL / 25

ONE LAST THING...

- Can you nod your head to it?
- If not, what one thing would you change?

